

HR-001: Leave and Time Off Policy

Kestrel Works | Department: HR | Version: 3.2 | Effective: 2026-04-01 | Owner: People Operations
Fictional document created for a software demo. Not a real policy.

1. Purpose and scope

Applies to: Employees, Contractors

This policy sets out the leave available to people working at Kestrel Works. Entitlements differ for employees and contractors. The leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March.

2. Leave entitlements for employees

Applies to: Employees

Full-time employees receive the annual entitlements below. Part-time employees receive them pro rata.

Leave type	Days per year	Carry forward	Notice required
Earned leave	18	Up to 10 days	5 working days
Casual leave	8	None	1 working day
Sick leave	10	None	Same day; medical note after 3 days
Maternity leave	182 (26 weeks)	Not applicable	8 weeks
Paternity leave	10	Not applicable	2 weeks
Bereavement leave	5	None	Same day

Earned leave above the carry-forward limit lapses on 31 March. Unused earned leave is paid out only on exit, up to a maximum of 30 days.

3. Time off for contractors

Applies to: Contractors

Contractors are not entitled to paid leave from Kestrel Works. Time off is unpaid and is agreed with the engagement manager. Contractors must give 3 working days of notice for planned absence.

Item	Contractor rule
Paid leave	None
Unpaid time off	Up to 12 days per 6-month engagement, with manager agreement
Company holidays	Not billable unless work is requested in writing
Sick days	Unpaid; inform the engagement manager the same day

4. How to apply

Applies to: Employees, Contractors

Employees apply in the PeopleHub portal and need line-manager approval. Contractors email their engagement manager and record the absence on their timesheet.